



TANZANIA WILDLIFE SAFARI

The Great Migration of the Serengeti is surely one of the world's most spectacular wildlife phenomena. Equally impressive are the self-contained ecosystem of Ngorongoro Crater and the diverse habitats of Tarangire National Park. This safari concentrates on these wildlife-rich areas so that you get more observation time and less travel than a trip that tries to cover too many areas superficially. Your guides know these areas well and can give you the very best experience possible.

Our May safari focuses on the short-grass plains, woodlands of the south east and western, and central Serengeti. It's the dry season in parks like Tarangire, so the river and marshes there attract large numbers of animals, both predator and prey.

If an African safari could be a once-in-a-lifetime experience for you, then make it the best! And do it with expert leadership, people who know the patterns and behaviors of wildlife—who not only can find and spot the wildlife but who also can provide the rich details of *context* that makes this more than merely accumulating lists. If you want an in-depth natural history experience of responsible ecotourism, then this is the trip for you.



Northern Tanzania Wildlife Safari

Day 1: Karibu!

Safari begins

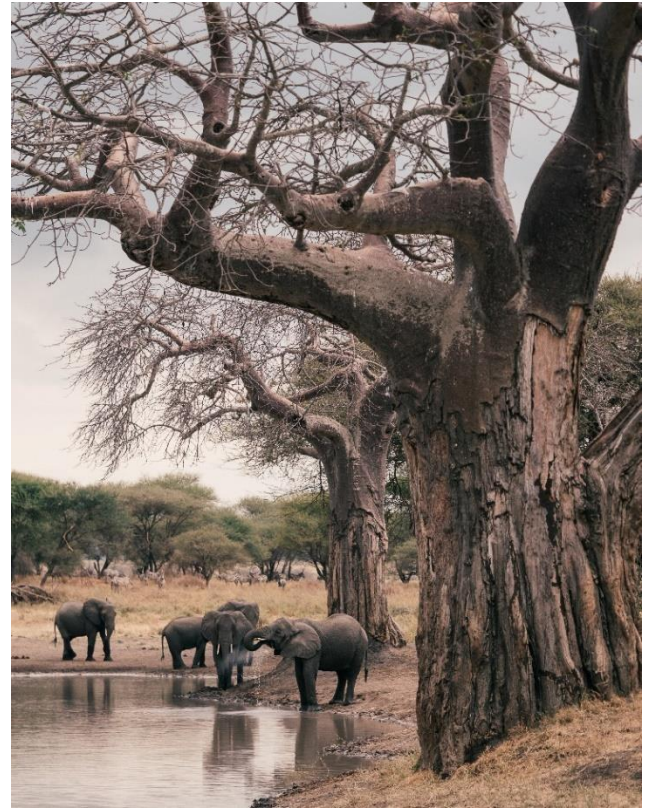
A representative from Aardvark Safaris Tanzania will meet and greet you as soon as you arrive at **Kilimanjaro International Airport (JRO)** and take you to the **Gran Melia Hotel**, for your overnight. Arusha, nestled in the shadow of majestic Mount Meru, is a dynamic, fast-growing town and a famed embarkation point for Tanzania safaris. Because of its altitude (roughly 4,600 feet above sea level), Arusha is blessed with a pleasant climate, perfect for the coffee plantations that surround it.

We are not simply trying to amass high species lists but also to take time to observe behavior and to soak in the beauty of the wildlife diversity. Patience can also yield wonderful photographic rewards.

Day 2:

Arusha to Tarangire National Park. Early morning after breakfast at your accommodation, drive straight to Tarangire National Park. South of Arusha is Tarangire National Park. Tarangire in the dry season is second only to Ngorongoro Crater in its concentrations of large wildlife. Its permanent water sources attract thousands of elephant, giraffe, wildebeest, zebra, eland, impala, buffalo, hartebeest, and warthog. We'll look for uncommon species such as gerenuk, oryx, and two species of kudu. These prey species attract the predators: lion, leopard, cheetah, and hyena. There are also the small critters (e.g., mongooses, hyraxes, squirrels) and incredible birds. The diverse landscape has open plains, stands of magnificent baobab trees, riverine forest, acacia parkland, scrub-woodlands, and wetlands. It is truly one of the best areas for birding and for mammal-watching in northern Tanzania.

We are staying **two nights** at **Tarangire Safari Lodge**, rated Excellent on Trip Advisor. You'll love the gorgeous views, the service, the delicious food, the surrounding wildness. Here we will have the rare opportunity to do a **night game drive (as an option)**, a privilege that few safari goers can get today. We'll look for nocturnal mammals that few see (for example, civet, genet, African porcupine, maybe even the odd armadillo) and predators during



their most-active periods. Lions and leopards at night are completely different from the snoozing animals to be found in mid-day. We feel that a night drive could well be among the finest highlights of your entire safari.

Day 3: Full day inside Tarangire National Park. Dinner and overnight at Tarangire Safari Lodge

Day 4-5: Tarangire to Serengeti National Park. We'll have three full days in the fabled Serengeti, one of the most productive and important wildlife areas in the world. With its vast rolling plains, dramatic outcrops of Precambrian rocks (kopjes), flattopped acacias, crocodile- and hippo-inhabited rivers lined with riverine gallery forests, and huge herds of animals, the Serengeti is about the ultimate in "wild Africa." The famous "Great Migration" of wildebeest, zebra, and other grazing herbivores is one of the last mass movements of animals still taking place on earth. We could not be here at a better time of year!



We are not simply trying to amass high species lists but also to take time to observe behavior and to soak in the beauty of the wildlife diversity. Patience can also yield wonderful photographic rewards. There is a lot of history here—both human and animal—and you will be enriched and informed by your guide Augustine so that you can get the big picture to complement the fascinating details that you will witness directly. Dinner and overnight at **Kubu Kubu Tented Lodge**

Day 6: Serengeti National Park to Ngorongoro Conservation Area (Ngorongoro Highlands). After an early breakfast we head out for another game drive en-route to Ngorongoro Conservation Area. We will stay at the beautiful ***Lion's Paw*** which sits on the rim of the crater.



Day 7: Ngorongoro Crater full day game drive.

Brace yourself for a trip back into the Pleistocene! Today we'll explore one of the world's largest calderas, 1011 miles in diameter and 2500 feet deep. This diverse ecosystem of forests, swamps, grasslands, and lakes supports lion, cheetah, serval, hyena, three kinds of jackal, zebra, rhino, hippo, elephant, and thousands of antelopes, including the massive eland. Because poaching is not a problem here, rare black rhinos and elephants with enormous tusks are present. Dinner and overnight at ***Lion's Paw***.

Day 8: Ngorongoro Highlands to Arusha. After breakfast depart for Arusha at ***Mount Meru Hotel***, where you will overnight.

Day 9: After lunch then you will be transferred to the airport for your onwards flight home.

Safari Cost: \$ 9,067 per person for safari

The safaris include the following:

- Land transportation using 4-wheel-drive vehicles with experienced driver-guides. Vehicles are equipped with radios for communication, first aid kits, and cool boxes for beverages (mineral water provided on game drives).
- Accommodations and meals in excellent lodges, camps, or hotels as indicated on the itinerary.
- Instruction and leadership by our tour leaders. Pre-departure Information on all aspects of the safari, including reading suggestions on the history, culture, and ecology of East Africa.
- Miscellaneous fees, such as park entrance fees, government taxes and levies, hotel taxes, normal portorage charges during the trip and *accommodation are subject to availability at the time of booking and therefore require booking and payment in advance.*
- Membership in the Flying Doctor Society in the unlikely event that emergency transportation to a hospital facility is required. Transportation only; hospital costs will be borne by the participant.

The safari does not include the following:

International airfare from and to USA or airport taxes, passport and visa fees, excess baggage charges, personal and baggage insurance, personal items (e.g., room service, laundry, medicines, phone or e-mail bills), beverages (except coffee/tea at meals and mineral water on game drives), photographic expenses, optional activities/excursions (e.g., balloon flights, village visits), expenses incurred if you arrive earlier than the arrival date or leave later than the departure date. Tips to driver-guides and leaders are an important show of appreciation; guidelines will be provided.